PADHAKU
Kaveri · Class 9 English

CHAPTER 8

Follow That Dream

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ Follow That Dream · Reflect and Respond

I 1 What is your dream?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

My dream is to become a doctor and serve people in villages where there are few hospitals.

I 2 Who inspires you to dream?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

My parents and my teachers inspire me. They work hard and always tell me that I can do anything if I try.

I 3 What qualities should you have in order to fulfil your dream?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Hard work and patience
- Self-belief and courage
- Discipline and good time management
- Not giving up after failure

I 4 Abdul Kalam said, "Dream is not that you see in sleep, dream is something that does not let you sleep." Discuss.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

A real dream is not a picture we see while sleeping. It is a strong goal that keeps us thinking, planning and working day and night until we achieve it.

II **What role can parents and community play to help children achieve their dreams?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Parents can encourage children, believe in them and support their studies.
- The community can give libraries, sports grounds, scholarships and good role models.
- Both can guide children and help them after failures.

III **Complete the web chart: Why is it important to follow a dream? Give as many reasons as you can.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- It gives our life a purpose and direction.
- It keeps us motivated and hard-working.
- It helps us discover our talents.
- It brings happiness and satisfaction.
- It builds confidence and self-belief.
- Our success can help our family and society.

Follow That Dream · Check Your Understanding

I 1 **Reaching the peak of skill in a field typically demands a focused and intense dedication for about a decade.**

✔ ANSWER

True. The mother says one must pursue the subject “for at least ten years”.

I 2 **The mother believes that significant effort and personal sacrifices are essential for turning aspirations into reality.**

✔ ANSWER

True. Greatness depends on “how much effort and sacrifice people invest”.

I 3 **The path to achieving the deepest desires has very little difficulty or a few obstacles.**

✔ ANSWER

False. “The road may be uphill most of the way.”

I 4 **The mother is of the opinion that a person’s life goals and hopes can evolve over time.**

✔ ANSWER

True. “Life itself may change a person’s dreams.”

I 5 **Having a strong network of individuals can be a hurdle in pursuing one’s ambition.**

✔ ANSWER

False. A support network helps; every Academy Award winner thanks such people.

I 6 **The mother feels that pursuing a major life goal will not involve any financial expense or sacrifice.**

✔ ANSWER

False. She says, “Count the cost in years of effort, financial investments and sacrifice.”

I 7 **For many individuals, their aspirations remain just wishes because they don’t move beyond mere daydreaming.**

✔ ANSWER

True. They “have never got beyond just wishful thinking”.

⭐ Follow That Dream · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Extract: “It starts with a passion for a particular interest...”**

Complete the analogy: enthusiasm : passion :: belief : _____

✔ ANSWER

conviction

I 1 (ii) A realistic assessment of effort, investment and sacrifice is crucial for preventing _____.

A. the need for external support network

B. an early abandonment of the dream

C. initial excitement from fading over time

D. others from questioning one's commitment

✔ ANSWER

B. an early abandonment of the dream – if you count the cost first, you will not give up halfway.

I 1 (iii) The word 'plunge' as used in the extract indicates a _____ (complete/gradual) involvement in a task.

✔ ANSWER

complete

I 1 (iv) **The emphasis on ‘doing what you love best and are doing the right thing’ works as a form of intrinsic motivation because _____.**

✔ ANSWER

because the joy and satisfaction come from within the person, not from rewards or praise from others, so it keeps them going even when the road is uphill.

I 1 (v) **Mention one motivating factor besides ‘prospect of success’ that might keep a person on track despite running out of stamina.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The support of family, friends and teachers (a support network), or the person’s own passion for the work.

I 2 (i) **‘Life itself may change a person’s dreams’ suggests that dreams are not static but rather _____ (evolving/dynamic).**

✔ ANSWER

evolving (they change and grow over time).

I 2 (ii) **What does the author mean by 'hopes and aspirations are no less than the original dream of younger days'?**

✔ ANSWER

She means that the new dreams which come later in life are just as important and valuable as the dreams we had when we were young.

I 2 (iii) **Identify the phrase from the extract that indicates a complex and challenging journey.**

✔ ANSWER

"negotiate a path through a maze of hurdles"

I 2 (iv) **'People who are participants in your dreamscape would be many more' because _____.**

✔ ANSWER

because a bigger dream that takes longer needs the help and support of many people, such as family, friends, guides and co-workers.

I 2 (v) **What is the tone of the author in this extract?**

A. appreciative and celebratory

B. excited and cheerful

C. optimistic and encouraging

D. eager and inquisitive

✔ ANSWER

C. optimistic and encouraging – she accepts hurdles but tells Ming that changed dreams can still come true.

II 1 The letter begins, 'By all means follow that dream'. What do you think Ming must have written to her mother about?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Ming must have written about a dream or ambition she wanted to pursue, perhaps a career or a field she loved, and asked whether she should follow it.

II 2 How can one attain an international level of skill in any field? Mention any two ways.

✔ ANSWER

- By pursuing the subject singularly and intensively for at least ten years.
- By having a passion and firm conviction, and investing effort, money and sacrifice to realise it.

II 3 What differentiates the mere dreamers from actual achievers?

✔ ANSWER

Achievers put in great effort and sacrifice and pursue their dream till it comes true. Mere dreamers only say “I wish I could be this or the other” and never go beyond wishful thinking.

Q 4 **How does Ming’s mother use critical questions and personal anecdotes to persuade Ming and convey her message effectively?**

✔ ANSWER

- She asks, “Do you know that to reach world-class standard... one has to be... pursuing the subject for at least ten years?” This makes Ming think about the effort needed.
- She gives real examples: people who could not go to Raffles College because of the Japanese invasion, and people who left school to support siblings.
- She shares her own story: publishing her book was a dream she chased for ten years. This makes her advice believable and warm.

Q 5 **How does Ming’s mother balance encouragement with caution in her advice?**

✔ ANSWER

She encourages Ming to follow her dream and plunge into it, but she also warns her to count the cost in effort, money, sacrifice and years. She says she is not putting “a wet blanket” on the dream, only asking her to think carefully first.

Q 6 **Is this advice about the challenges of pursuing dreams still relevant in contemporary society? Why or why not?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Yes. Even today, success needs years of hard work, money and sacrifice. Many people still give up dreams because of money problems, family duties or sudden changes like a pandemic. So planning, effort and a support network are still important.

Q 7 **What ‘costs’ in terms of effort, sacrifice, and time are you willing or unwilling to invest to pursue your goals?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I am willing to study for extra hours, give up some TV and phone time and practise regularly for years. I am unwilling to sacrifice my health or my time with family completely.

Follow That Dream · Vocabulary and Structures in Context

I **Find the meanings: mindscape, seascape, landscape, cityscape.**

✔ ANSWER

- **mindscape**: the inner world of a person's thoughts and feelings
- **seascape**: a view or picture of the sea
- **landscape**: a view of an area of land, e.g. hills, fields, forests
- **cityscape**: a view of a city, its buildings and lights

I 1 **Fill in the blanks (mindscape, seascape, landscape, cityscape):**

Sneha: Your Goa pictures were beautiful! That (i) ___ was dreamy.

Kiran: Thanks! It was way better than our usual (ii) ___, so peaceful.

Sneha: ...sometimes the city lights have their own charm.

Kiran: True, but I'm craving a quiet (iii) ___. Forests, hills—something real.

Sneha: Yes, nature clears the (iv) ___, doesn't it?

✔ ANSWER

(i) **seascape**

(ii) **cityscape**

(iii) **landscape**

(iv) **mindscape**

II 1 **She had a dream that seemed to burn in her blood...**

(i) make her angry (ii) have a passionate desire (iii) cause physical pain (iv) become violent

✔ ANSWER

(ii) have a passionate desire

Sentence: His wish to become a pilot burns in his blood.

II 2 **Preparing for the final exam without proper notes felt like an uphill task.**

(i) a tough challenge (ii) a slow progress (iii) a hard routine (iv) a difficult choice

✔ ANSWER

(i) a tough challenge

Sentence: Learning to swim at the age of forty was an uphill task for my uncle.

Q 3 The team was **buoyed up** by their recent victory...

(i) energised by success (ii) encouraged by the result (iii) motivated to improve (iv) lifted in spirit

✔ ANSWER

(iv) lifted in spirit

Sentence: She was buoyed up by her teacher's kind words before the exam.

Q 4 ...but that was just **wishful thinking**.

(i) a clever shortcut but no real effort behind it (ii) a confident guess but lacking proper knowledge (iii) a hopeful belief but unlikely to be true (iv) a strong desire but based on facts and planning

✔ ANSWER

(iii) a hopeful belief but unlikely to be true

Sentence: Hoping to win the race without practice is just wishful thinking.

Q 5 Don't be a **wet blanket**—we're trying to have fun!

(i) spoil-sport (ii) latecomer (iii) rule-breaker (iv) daydreamer

✔ ANSWER

(i) spoil-sport

Sentence: Raju was a wet blanket at the party and kept complaining about the music.

II 6 Excitement was **coursing through her veins** as she stepped onto the stage...

(i) hiding deep inside (ii) flowing through her body (iii) lingering in her thoughts (iv) causing numbness

✔ ANSWER

(ii) flowing through her body

Sentence: Joy was coursing through his veins when he saw his result.

III **Complete the sentences using your own words (imperatives).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. If the idea excites you, **go ahead and try it**.
2. If you hear strange noises, **call your parents at once**.
3. If this seems too hard, **ask your teacher for help**.
4. If you care about the issue, **raise your voice about it**.
5. If you finish early, **check your answers again**.

IV **Match each 'could' with its function: past ability or purpose / possibility / past**

possibility or speculation / unreal or hypothetical situation.

1. It could be in any field—sports, science, arts, business or design.

2. “I wish I could be this or the other,”...

3. They could have preferred to trade their dream for security.

4. ...they had to go out to work so that they could support their siblings through school.

✔ ANSWER

1. **Possibility**
2. **Unreal or hypothetical situation**
3. **Past possibility or speculation**
4. **Past ability or purpose**

V **Complete using ‘could’ with the functions in brackets.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. I wish **I could travel the world** without worrying about money. (unreal)
2. They **could have taken** the shorter route, but they didn’t know about it. (past possibility)
3. When I was younger, I **could run for an hour** without stopping. (past ability)
4. She **could be at** the library right now—she had mentioned it. (possibility)
5. **Could you please** repeat the question? I didn’t hear it clearly. (polite request)

VI Fill in the blanks with suitable forms of the words in brackets (Experiential learning...).

✔ ANSWER

1. **helps**
2. **learned/learnt**
3. **work**
4. **apply**
5. **conducts**
6. **analyses**
7. **must reflect**
8. **helps**
9. **is**
10. **will incorporate**

⭐ Follow That Dream · Listen and Respond

11 Vocational courses will begin in the month of _____.

✔ ANSWER

April (forms from Monday, 04 April)

12 The objective of the courses is to prepare you with _____ for future studies and jobs.

✔ ANSWER

practical skills

13 Offered courses include Graphic Design, _____, Web Application, and Entrepreneurship Skills, etc.

✔ ANSWER

Basic Coding

14 Classes will be conducted by _____ at school.

✔ ANSWER

trained professionals

15 The application forms will be available at the _____.

✔ ANSWER

school office

16 Choice of course will be given to _____ applicants.

✔ ANSWER

early

Follow That Dream · Speaking Activity

1 Role play in groups of four: the Dreamer (wants to be a trekking guide), a Parent (worried about money), a Mentor/Teacher

(balanced advice), a Friend/Sibling (supportive).

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Dreamer: I know this might sound challenging, but I want to be a trekking guide. Ever since I was a child, I've dreamed of the mountains. It's an uphill journey, but I'm ready for it because I love nature.

Parent: I know you're passionate, but will it give you a steady income? I only want what's best for you. What if it doesn't work out?

Mentor: Remember, dreams need planning. Let's look at the long-term view. There are ways to combine your dream and a degree in tourism. Are you ready to train hard?

Friend: You've always been good at climbing, don't give up now. I don't want to be a wet blanket, but what's your backup plan? If anyone can do this, it's you.

⭐ Follow That Dream · Writing Task

I **Write an email to the Director of a reputed design institute enquiring about the details of its summer workshop and expressing your interest in joining it.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

From: riya.sharma@example.com

To: director@designinstitute.example.com

Cc:

Bcc:

Date: 10 April 2026

Subject: Enquiry about the Summer Design Workshop

Message:

Respected Sir/Madam,

I am Riya Sharma, a student of Class 9 at Government Girls Senior Secondary School, Delhi. I came across the notice of the summer workshop being conducted by your institute. I am passionate about designing and wish to pursue a course in design in future.

I would be grateful if you could kindly share the details of the workshop, such as the dates, timings, duration, eligibility, fee and the last date of registration. I would also like to know whether students need to bring any materials.

I am very keen to join this workshop and learn from your experienced faculty. I request you to kindly allow me to register for it. I look forward to your reply.

Yours sincerely,

Riya Sharma

Student, Class 9

Mobile: 98XXXXXXXX

📘 Follow That Dream · Learning Beyond the Text

I **Create a Vision Board for yourself: My Dreams, I Want to Try, Goals, Places I Will Go, Inspiration.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **My Dreams:** become a scientist at ISRO
- **I Want to Try:** start a journal, learn to play the flute, join the school play
- **Goals:** read 10 books this year, improve my handwriting and writing, score above 85 % in Maths
- **Places I Will Go:** the Himalayas, Andaman Islands, the Moon (dream destination)
- **Inspiration:** Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam; my mother; quote "Dream, dream, dream"

II **Great personalities in history were inspired by their parents (Jijabai and Shivaji; Queen Madālasa and her sons). Read and discuss.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Jijabai told Shivaji tales from the Ramayana and Mahabharata and gave him a sense of dharma, patriotism and justice; this shaped his bravery and leadership.
- Queen Madālasa taught her children about the soul and detachment from material desires, guiding them to seek spiritual liberation.

- Lesson: parents' values and stories can shape a child's dreams and character.

⭐ Believe in Yourself · Reflect and Respond

I 1 **Imagine you are the person in the image. What emotions do you feel standing at the base of a difficult task?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I feel nervous, a little afraid and unsure, but also curious and excited about reaching the top.

I 2 **What might make you take the first step?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Belief in myself, the wish to reach my goal and encouragement from my family and friends.

II 1 **Think about a time when you had to face a challenge. What was it, and how did you feel at the start?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I had to speak on stage in the morning assembly for the first time. At the start I felt scared and my hands were shaking.

II 2 **How did you feel once you made the decision to move forward?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Once I decided to go ahead, I felt calmer and braver. After the speech I felt proud and confident.

III **What does ‘believe in yourself’ mean to you? Write some words or phrases you associate with it.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

It means trusting your own abilities.

- confidence
- self-trust
- courage
- never give up
- positive attitude
- I can do it

IV Select the meaning of ‘status quo’: “...most of them were happy with the status quo and didn’t want any changes.”

1. A plan to make things more exciting.
2. A situation to keep things the same.
3. A decision where everything is completely different.
4. A choice to change things quickly without thinking.

✔ ANSWER

2. A situation to keep things the same. The kids “didn’t want any changes”.

⭐ Believe in Yourself · Check your Understanding

I Stanza 1 **(i) Facing challenges requires personal responsibility and a clear focus on one’s future.**

(ii) Facing challenges is a journey best taken with support and guidance from others.

✔ ANSWER

(i) – “There is no crowd... It’s just you and the future.”

I Stanza 2 **(i) Fear and uncertainty make it difficult to make choices as the future approaches.**

(ii) Facing the future with confidence makes choices easier and more straightforward.

✔ ANSWER

(i) – "Difficult are choices / When the future is getting near."

I Stanza 3

(i) Personal growth involves finding balance between comfort and change.

(ii) Personal growth requires leaving behind comfort and embracing change.

✔ ANSWER

(ii) – staying in comfort "isn't how we grow".

I Stanza 4

(i) The first step towards change may feel easy if you place your trust in others...

(ii) The first step towards change is difficult, but having self-belief and confidence helps you stay on track.

✔ ANSWER

(ii) – "The first step is the hardest... believe in yourself."

II The poem follows a simple, yet effective rhyme scheme _____ that flows steadily through each stanza.

✔ ANSWER

abcb (lines 2 and 4 rhyme: see/be, fear/near, quo/grow, back/track).

III 1 The overall tone of the poem is motivational and encouraging.

✔ ANSWER

True

III 2 The tone shifts from thoughtful in the beginning to one of determination by the end of the poem.

✔ ANSWER

True

IV The speaker... comes across as a _____ (stranger/guide) who... is encouraging the reader to take _____ (interest in/control of) his/her own future. The use of 'You' creates a close connection, as though the speaker is _____.

✔ ANSWER

guide

control of
talking directly to the reader

V **Match Column 1 with Column 2 (one extra):**

1. There is no crowd to see...

2. push you back in fear?

(i) Represents the difficulty of beginning a new challenge or change.

(ii) Suggests a solitary journey, stressing individual effort.

(iii) Evokes the mental barrier that prevents growth.

✔ ANSWER

1 → **(ii)** Suggests a solitary journey, stressing individual effort.

2 → **(iii)** Evokes the mental barrier that prevents growth.

VI **Words: unknown, self-improvement, courage, leap of faith, stagnation**

1. Comfort and the status quo represent ___ and fear of change...

2. The future symbolises the ___ ... but requires ___ to step into.

3. The first step symbolises the initial ___ required to begin the journey of ___ or personal development.

✔ ANSWER

1. **stagnation**
2. **unknown**; **courage**
3. **leap of faith**; **self-improvement**

VII **The poet uses a metaphor in the line, 'The first step is the hardest'. Explain why this is metaphorical.**

✔ ANSWER

It does not mean a real step taken with the feet. The 'first step' stands for the beginning of any change or challenge, which is the most difficult part because we must overcome fear and leave our comfort zone.

VIII **Identify the lines from the poem that show antithesis and explain why it is so.**

✔ ANSWER

- "Will it **pull you forward** / Or **push you back** in fear?" – 'pull forward' and 'push back' are opposite ideas in a parallel structure.
- "There is such ease in comfort / To maintain the status quo, / But this isn't what we are made for / This isn't how we grow." – the ease of staying the same is contrasted with growth.

The contrast shows the choice between moving ahead and staying stuck.

⭐ Believe in Yourself · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **What does the line ‘There is no crowd to see’ suggest about facing challenges?**

✔ ANSWER

It suggests that we often face challenges alone. No one is watching or cheering; we must find the courage within ourselves.

I 1 (ii) **The line ‘It’s just you and the future’ suggests that _____.**

✔ ANSWER

the person alone is responsible for his/her future and must decide where he/she wants to be.

I 1 (iii) **Latha will _____ her efforts to improve her vocal performance by practicing harder each day.**

✔ ANSWER

step up

I 1 (iv) **Select the most suitable title for the extract.**

A. The Struggles of Change

B. Facing the Future Alone

C. A Journey of Growth

D. The Power of Fear

✔ ANSWER

B. Facing the Future Alone – the extract says there is no crowd, "just you and the future".

I 1 (v) **Complete the analogy: achieve : goal :: face : _____**

✔ ANSWER

challenge (we achieve a goal; we face a challenge)

II 1 **What is the significance of the metaphor 'The first step is the hardest' in the context of personal growth?**

✔ ANSWER

Growth begins with leaving our comfort zone. The start is hardest because of fear and doubt, but once we take it, the journey becomes easier and we begin to grow. So the first step is the most important one.

II 2 **What message does the antithesis in the poem convey about the nature of personal development?**

✔ ANSWER

It shows that we always have two choices: move forward or stay back in fear and comfort. Personal development means choosing change and challenge over the easy status quo.

II 3 **Do you think the poet's message is realistic in the context of real-world struggles?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Partly. Self-belief is the first and necessary step, but alone it is not enough. We also need hard work, planning, skills, guidance and support from others, and sometimes luck and resources. Belief gives the courage to begin; effort completes the journey.

II 4 **Consider a situation where you or someone you know had to take a difficult first step towards a goal. How does the poem's message about self-belief apply?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

My elder sister wanted to join the police but was afraid of the physical test. She believed in herself, started running every morning and finally passed. Like the poem says, the first step was the hardest, but self-belief kept her on track.

I **Fill in the blanks with Latin expressions (et cetera, exempli gratia, ad hoc, in media res, per se, quid pro quo).**

✔ ANSWER

(i) I enjoy reading fantasy books, **e.g. (exempli gratia)** Harry Potter and Magical Paint Brush.

(ii) ...Ritu asked for a **quid pro quo** to borrow her notes next time.

(iii) ...trekking, hiking, biking, **etc. (et cetera)**.

(iv) The park is not very special **per se**; it becomes more fun when you visit with friends.

(v) We created an **ad hoc** team to organise the school festival.

(vi) The movie started **in media res**, with the hero already fighting the villain.

II 1 (i) **Isn't it obvious that we must act now? Don't we all have a responsibility to make a change?**

✔ ANSWER

It aims to create urgency and persuade people to take action together; it reminds everyone of their responsibility.

II 1 (ii) **Will we let fear control us, or will we rise above it?**

✔ ANSWER

It aims to motivate people to be brave and overcome their fear.

II 2 **Match situations with rhetorical questions:**

(i) Deciding whether to stand up for what is right

(ii) Owning up to a mistake made in a group project

(iii) Deciding whether to try something challenging, like public speaking

(iv) Choosing between two career paths

(v) Deciding whether to apologise for a mistake

(vi) Trying something new and stepping out of your comfort zone

A. How can we ever grow if we never try anything new?

B. Isn't it better to admit our mistakes than to let them define us?

C. If I don't take responsibility now, when will I?

D. Can I really move forward without knowing which path to take?

E. What's the point of playing it safe if it means staying stuck?

F. How can we stay silent when we know what is right?

✔ ANSWER

(i) → **F**
(ii) → **C**
(iii) → **A**
(iv) → **D**
(v) → **B**
(vi) → **E**

⭐ Believe in Yourself · Listen and Respond

I 1 How did the boy feel before the play?

✔ ANSWER

nervous

I 2 According to the girl, where does confidence come from?

✔ ANSWER

taking action

I 3 What was the girl finally sure about regarding the boy?

✔ ANSWER

that he would **shine** (“I know you’ll shine!”)

II **Select the four true statements from 1–7.**

✔ ANSWER

True: **2, 4, 5, 7**

- 2. The girl asks him to trust himself and his practice.
- 4. She says self-doubt is part of the process.
- 5. He feels he is not good enough even though he has put in the work.
- 7. She says pushing yourself helps you grow and become confident.

(1 is false: he is nervous, not confident. 3 and 6 are not said.)

🧪 Believe in Yourself · Speaking Activity

1 **Don't judge a book by its cover. (Explain, give a situation, conclude; role play in pairs.)**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: We should not judge people by their looks or first impression.

Situation: A new boy in our class wore old clothes and was quiet. Some of us thought he was weak in studies, but he topped the Maths test and helped us all.

Lesson: Know a person before judging.

Role play: A: “He looks so dull, he can’t be good at anything.” B (later): “Hi, I’m Arun. I love solving puzzles—want me to help with this sum?” A: “I was wrong about you!”

2 **Actions speak louder than words.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: What we do matters more than what we say.

Role play: A: “From tomorrow I’ll study three hours daily and top the class!” (but keeps playing games). B quietly makes a timetable, studies daily and improves her marks.

Lesson: Real effort, not big promises, brings results.

3 **When the going gets tough, the tough get going.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: Strong people work harder when things become difficult.

Role play: A: “This science project is too hard, I’m quitting.” B: “Don’t give up! Let’s break it into small parts and do one each day.” A finishes it and wins a prize.

Lesson: Perseverance leads to success despite difficulties.

⭐ Believe in Yourself · Writing Task

I **Draft a speech for the morning assembly on ‘Turning Challenges into Opportunities’.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Turning Challenges into Opportunities

Good morning respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends. I am Aman of Class 9 B. Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam once said, “Difficulties in your life do not come to destroy you, but to help you realise your hidden potential.” Today I will talk about why we fear challenges and how we can turn them into opportunities.

Firstly, why do we feel scared when things change? Change takes us out of our comfort zone and we fear failure. Yet every challenge brings a chance to learn. Think of Dr. Kalam, who delivered newspapers before dawn to pay for school. That hard job taught him discipline and responsibility, which later made him the ‘Missile Man of India’.

Secondly, how can we face challenges with a positive mindset? We can break a big problem into small steps, ask for help, learn from mistakes and believe in ourselves. When I failed my first Maths test, I started practising daily and asking doubts. Next time I scored much better, and I gained confidence too. Isn’t it true that the problems we solve make us stronger?

To sum up, challenges build skills, determination and confidence, all of which are essential for success. So, the next time life gives you a difficulty, don't you agree it is better to see it as a door to a new opportunity? Thank you.

📘 Believe in Yourself · Learning Beyond the Text

I **Find out about personalities from your village, town, city or state who turned challenges into opportunities, and present their success stories in class (examples: Dr. B. R. Ambedkar, Lal Bahadur Shastri, Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam).**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Points for your presentation:

- Name and place of the person
- The difficulty or hardship they faced (poverty, discrimination, illness, lack of schools...)
- What they did: hard work, study, courage, help from others
- What they achieved and how it helped others
- What we learn from them

> Example: Dr. B. R. Ambedkar faced humiliation and discrimination at school but never gave up; through grit and hard work he studied Politics and Economics and became Chairperson of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution of India.

🎉 **Chapter 8 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**